

Maria Silva

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LLB and LLM graduate with practical experience in regulatory advice, legal research, document coordination and client communication at BCLP, Citizens Advice and Q-Legal. Experienced in managing procedural and regulatory materials under deadline pressure, conducting statutory and regulatory analysis, and advising clients on complex legal requirements. Developing interest in financial services and fund-related work, supported by independent study in private equity. Seeking a financial services regulatory paralegal role where research, filing coordination and client contact are central responsibilities.

EDUCATION

Comparative and International Dispute Resolution LLM — Merit Sept 2024 – Oct 2025

Queen Mary University of London

- Modules in international arbitration, dispute resolution procedure, legal research and evidence analysis
- Transnational Law and Governance Applied module (data privacy and democracy) — 75%
- Dissertation: data protection and GDPR development across jurisdictions

Law LLB — 2:1 Sept 2020 – June 2024

University College London

- Alternative Dispute Resolution, Advanced Contract Law, Commercial Law, Company Law

International Foundation Programme of Law and International Relations Sept 2019 – June 2020

King's College London

- Awarded the Leaders of Tomorrow prize (top 20 of 200-student cohort; partial funding toward undergraduate degree)

EXPERIENCE

Citizens Advice East Berkshire · Maidenhead July 2026 – Present

Legal Adviser

- Assesses eligibility for welfare benefits, housing support and related entitlements against statutory and regulatory criteria; identifies evidential gaps and researches complex points
- Manages matters from instruction through to submission: drafts correspondence, prepares applications and document schedules, maintains confidential case records, meets deadlines
- Advises clients on procedural requirements and available options; translates complex statutory rules into clear, practical guidance for clients in difficult circumstances
- Interviews clients across welfare, employment, housing, family, debt and consumer matters; takes detailed factual statements and establishes chronologies

Bryan Cave Leighton Paisner LLP (BCLP) · London Feb 2024 – Aug 2024

Legal Placement Student — International Arbitration

- Coordinated regulatory and procedural filing materials for a complex investment arbitration, including evidence review, document organisation and tracking of outstanding actions
- Drafted procedural orders and procedural histories; amended sections of the Claimant's memorial; conducted legal research to support submissions
- Became the sole junior supporting the team shortly before a significant deadline; coordinated documents and helped ensure on-time submission under pressure
- Liaised directly with the client on required documents; coordinated Romanian translations with an external translator
- Maintained structured electronic case files and monitored procedural deadlines throughout the matter
- Received feedback from a partner and associate that performance was comparable to a newly qualified solicitor

Bryan Cave Leighton Paisner LLP (BCLP) · London

Aug 2023 – Feb 2024

Legal Placement Student — Real Estate Disputes

- Supported hearing preparation: reviewed documents, prepared electronic bundles, assisted with skeleton arguments and court materials
- Conducted legal and factual research on rights of light, easements, leasehold issues and landlord and tenant disputes
- Assisted with court filings, matter opening and closure, deadline tracking and cost comparisons
- Managed large volumes of confidential documents across several matters with competing deadlines; maintained matter records via iManage

Q-Legal · London

Oct 2024 – Jan 2025

Legal Adviser

- Managed a data-privacy matter from client instruction through to formal written advice letter under a qualified solicitor's supervision
- Researched UK GDPR and Data Protection Act 2018 obligations for a data-driven start-up, including obligations around children's personal data and adtech
- Identified legal and compliance risks from the client's data processing and recommended practical mitigations
- Translated complex statutory requirements into clear, commercially focused advice; coordinated with the client and supervising solicitor to meet deadline

Adobe · London

June 2022 – Aug 2022

Legal Intern

- Reviewed and amended software licensing agreements; identified contractual risks and assessed alignment with internal legal and compliance requirements
- Reviewed confidentiality and data-processing provisions; researched UK GDPR, EU GDPR and cross-border personal data transfer requirements
- Liaised with sales, legal and international business teams to resolve contractual queries and reconcile commercial objectives with legal risk
- Prepared and delivered an internal presentation on breach-of-contract risks and mitigation measures

SKILLS

Languages: Portuguese (native), English (fluent), Spanish (basic)

Technical skills: Legal and regulatory research; documentary analysis; concise report writing; Microsoft Word, Excel and PowerPoint; iManage; legal research databases; electronic court filing portals; document review; electronic bundling; case management and time-recording systems. Self-directed study: Coursera Private Equity course (fund structures, leverage, value creation and exit strategies); Clifford Chance Real Estate Finance virtual experience programme.

Case and evidence management: Evidence review, hearing bundles, procedural and regulatory filing materials, procedural histories, case-file organisation, deadline tracking